“and it’s too close to call but there is no doubt the people are with us.”

Wednesday, July 29:

> The whole day was given to phone calls to Congressmen except for a half dozen to name ambassadors.
>
> I went from fearing the worst to hope we’d squeak through. As the day went on though some how I got the feeling that something good was happening. Then late afternoon came word the Senate had passed its tax bill [ours] 89 to 11. Then from the House where all the chips were down, we won 238-195. We got 40 Democrat votes. On final passage almost 100 joined the parade making it 330 odd to 107 or thereabouts. This on top of the budget victory is the greatest political win in half a century.
>
> Tip O’Neill and his leadership called me and with complete graciousness congratulated us on our win.
>
> Now we must make it work—and we will.

The economic program I’d brought to Washington six months earlier was now in place. Next on my agenda was realizing another dream I had brought with me: reducing the threat of nuclear war.